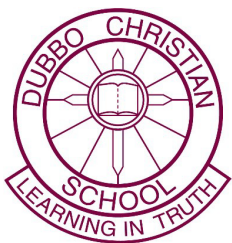




ANNUAL REPORT

2024



Dubbo Christian School
141 Sheraton Rd Dubbo 2830

(02) 6882 0044
info@dubbocs.edu.au

About this Report

This Annual Report for 2024 provides students, parents, staff and the wider school community with information about various aspects of this school's distinctiveness, performance and development. The report is a legislative requirement under *The Education Amendment (Non-Government Schools Registration) Act 2004*.

Information contained on OurDCS, the Sentral for Parents App and DCS Newsletters (available from the school) complement the information in this report.

The school has policy and procedures in place to ensure its participation in annual reporting to publicly disclose the educational and financial performance measures and policies of the school as identified by the Minister.

141 Sheraton Road
PO Box 1216
Dubbo NSW 2830

Ph: (02) 6882 0044
Fax: (02) 6448 2907
Email: info@dubbocs.edu.au
Website:

www.dubbocs.edu.au ABN:

96 002 837 658

Contents

About this Report	2
From the Board	4
Principal's Welcome	6
About Dubbo Christian School	8
Characteristics of the Student Body	10
Retention Rates	11
Student Attendance	12
External Testing Results	13
Teacher Standards	17
Satisfaction with School	20
Financial Information.....	24
School Priorities 2024-2025	25
Respect and Responsibility	26
Information Regarding Key Policies	27

From the Board

As we reflect on the past year, we are once again reminded of God's unwavering faithfulness. Throughout the various challenges and successes, His provision has been constant.

The construction of the new Dubbo primary building is progressing well, and we eagerly anticipate the opportunities that the extra space will provide. In addition, the development of the new ovals is an exciting advancement that will offer significant benefits to our students.

There is also considerable anticipation surrounding the establishment of the new agriculture plot. If you

have not yet had the opportunity to view this area, we encourage you to do so and appreciate the work that has gone into creating this facility.

We extend our sincere thanks to Paul Arundell for his Godly leadership and the substantial contribution he has made to Dubbo Christian School (DCS) over the past three years. While Mr Arundell will conclude his role as Principal of DCS at the end of 2025, we are grateful that he has agreed to continue serving as Executive Principal of Berakah Christian Education in 2026, thereby ensuring continuity across our schools.



Cinderella

Mrs Jo Blatch stepped down as the WCS Principal at the end of Term 1, 2024. We wish to acknowledge and thank Mr Isaac Kinscher for his service as Acting Principal of Wellington Christian School (WCS) for stepping in during Terms 2-4 2024 and express our appreciation to Mr Carl Palmer who fulfilled the role of Principal at WCS for the first part of 2025. Regrettably, due to unforeseen circumstances, Mr Palmer has tendered his resignation from this role.

As we move forward, we trust in God's provision as we seek new principals for both DCS and WCS.

WCS has experienced a challenging year marked by leadership transitions. Nevertheless, we remain deeply thankful for those who have stepped forward to ensure the continued smooth operation of the school.

Dubbo Christian Preschool continues to flourish, maintaining strong enrolments and a full complement of dedicated teaching staff.

We are grateful for the ongoing commitment and involvement of our Association members. As a Board, we deeply appreciate their engagement and commitment. A strong and active membership base remains essential to the life and future of our schools.

The Board itself remains strong, and it is encouraging to see that committed and

competent individuals are willing to serve in this way. I extend my heartfelt thanks to our Board members for the effort, enthusiasm, and wisdom they bring to their roles. We would also like to recognise the considerable contribution that our previous Board chair, Andrew Boog, made while serving in this role for many years. We thank him and wish him well in his move to Glen Innes.

Our financial position also remains strong. Our objective is not the accumulation of wealth, but the faithful stewardship of resources to better fulfil our mission.

School community events, such as the twilight fete and the thanksgiving service have continued to foster connection and we are grateful for the staff who work hard to make these events happen.

While we look back with gratitude on the blessings of the past year, we remain mindful of the need to commit our schools to God daily, seeking His continued guidance and provision in all that we do.

Your Sincerely,

Shane Duke
Board Chair



Principal's Welcome

I am encouraged that the 2024 Annual Report speaks of stability, growth and confidence. Stability because of God's faithfulness to his people as they honour him in word and deed. Growth, because of the faithfulness of his people in living daily in faith, hope and love, such that people are drawn to a community of care, stability and joy. In turn this creates confidence to remain resolute in pursuing the values and attitudes that are the hallmark of this community.

Happily, the pressures of previous years that had left our staff and the wider community with limited margin, were replaced this year with consolidated growth, full staffing, settled classes and the joy of being able to relax and even smell our beautiful roses. Our joy as a community was particularly apparent at the Fete which showcased the friendliness of our culture and the sense of belonging and inclusivity that is a feature of the school. The fireworks were pretty good as well.

A great feature of the year was the introduction of PeaceWise Kids and Youth throughout the school. Designed to equip students to understand and manage conflict more effectively, staff have noticed greater resilience and capacity amongst students to

de-escalate conflict before it threatens to destabilise and undermine friendships. In a world full of conflict, it is vital that we help them to understand that choosing to be a peacemaker will help them to succeed in life and to leave the world a better place than they found it.

It was also good to welcome Nicole Janetzki to the newly created position of Director of Wellbeing. This was in response to the Board's Strategic Plan which prioritised the strengthening of the Christian distinctives of the school and strengthening support for student wellbeing. Nicole has worked closely with the student leaders to enable them to strengthen and maintain our positive student culture and has overseen the implementation of PeaceWise. Nicole is also working with staff to review and improve the PCG program.

As mentioned, our student population has seen continued steady growth. This is in line with the National growth of Independent Christian Schools like ours, which is the fastest growing sector in education.

Nationwide, parents are choosing our schools because of excellent education outcomes that are tied to Christian love and faith in action. The feedback I receive from parents when they are enrolling at DCS is that they want their children here because they notice the values, attitudes and behaviour of our students and they hear from friends and colleagues that it is a great school.

My thanks, therefore, goes to everyone who has contributed to making 2024 the success that it was. Community is about recognising and celebrating all our members and the part they play in praying, volunteering, encouraging us all to play our part and to support the vision for authentic and rigorous Christ centred education here in Dubbo.

It is also appropriate to acknowledge and thank the Berakah Board who tirelessly serve the school, unseen and often unacknowledged. I would

particularly like to celebrate and recognise Andrew Boog who stepped down in November as Board Chair, after many years of faithful service. Andrew's tenacity and skill in strengthening our school's governance practice has been phenomenal and he has thereby left a legacy of solid and professional governance that will serve the school for years to come. We are also indebted to Shane Duke for stepping into the large shoes of Andrew so capably and to the whole Board who continue to lead with integrity and wisdom.

As we reflect on the many achievements of the school and its people in 2024, let's never stop giving thanks and praise to God who is the reason for our existence and enables DCS to continue in its goal of "Learning In Truth."

I commend this report to you, and the success of its people, under God.

Paul Arundell

BCE Executive Principal



About Dubbo Christian School

The mission of Dubbo Christian School (DCS) is to ***provide authentic, responsive and high-quality education that is Bible-based and Christ-centered to prepare, equip and transform lives.***

Our approach to education is ***Bible-based and Christ-centered***. God has revealed through the Bible much of how He would have us live and what we should do, and honest examination of the relevant biblical principles have been undertaken on a wide range of school issues. Our school motto is ***Learning in Truth***, as Jesus said, “*I am the way and the truth and the life*” (John 14:6). We aim to keep Him in the centre of all we do as a school.

DCS acknowledges that the total process of education is firstly and ultimately the responsibility of parents and carers. This responsibility is shared by delegation with the school, the church, other people and agencies. While not being responsible for the whole process, the school accepts from parents and carers the delegated responsibility to perform specific tasks on behalf of parents.

We strive to provide our students with ***authentic, responsive and high-quality***

education. The education we provide our students is carefully planned and delivered in a way that meets their needs, yet challenges them to grow. As a school, we do not settle for mediocrity or an “anything goes” approach. Students are expected to be diligent in working with others in the development of all their gifts and potential abilities. These gifts are to be used for the service of God and others.

All of the above and more is done with the aim to ***prepare, equip and transform*** the lives of our students so that when they leave school they will be wise and confident people with a strong foundation who know their place in the world.

DCS is a modern, well-established and strongly resourced co-educational Preschool to Year 12 day school set in a peaceful rural setting. DCS was established in 1983 by a group of local Christian parents who had a vision for education that was authentically Christian in outlook and practice. Since then, the school has grown in both influence and number, being made up of students from Dubbo and surrounds.

Year 11 Hike 2024



Characteristics of the Student Body

Population

During 2024, DCS had 694 students enrolled. 642 students were enrolled for the whole year. 40 students commenced and 52 students left during the year, five of whom came and left in the same year.

Class Breakdown

The Kindergarten to Year 6 section of the school had 318 students in 13 classes. This was comprised of both single age and composite age classes.

The Years 7 to 10 section of the school had 288 students enrolled. This was comprised of three classes for core subjects in each year group

There were 88 students in the Years 11 and 12 section of the school. 24 subjects were delivered Year 11 and 28 subjects delivered to Year 12.

Gender Breakdown

There were 360 female students and 334 male students enrolled at DCS in 2024.

Indigenous Students

53 students identified as being Indigenous in 2024. This number was comprised of 33 female and 20 male students. 30 of these students were in Years K-6 and 23 in Years 7-12. 40 of these students were enrolled for the entire year.



Retention Rates

Retention rates for 2024 are reported according to the number of students moving from Year 6 to Year 7, and those moving from Year 10 in 2022 to the **completion** of Year 12 in 2024 at DCS.

Year 7, 2024

30 students completed Year 6 at DCS in 2023.

49 students commenced Year 7 in 2024, including 22 new students.

This produces an actual retention rate of 90%.

Year 12, 2024

60 students completed Year 10 at DCS in 2022. 35 returned to commence Year 11 in 2023. 32 of these students completed Year 12 at DCS in 2024. This is a 53% retention of students who attended Year 10 at DCS.

Three students transferred to DCS during 2023-24.

A total of 34 students completed Year 12 in 2024.

This produces an apparent retention rate of 57% and an actual retention rate of 53%. Eleven of the 34 students, 32%, who completed Year 12 in 2024, had been enrolled in DCS since Kindergarten.

Agriculture students laying turf for new Ovals



Student Attendance

The table below shows the attendance rate of students in Kindergarten to Year 12 (K-12) in 2024. This is absolute data and does not take into account reason for absence. Total K-12 2024 whole year attendance was 88.8%.

	Male	Female	Total
Kindergarten	89.2%	92.4%	90.7%
Year 1	89.2%	90.7%	90.0%
Year 2	92.4%	87.6%	90.0%
Year 3	92.4%	90.1%	91.3%
Year 4	89.9%	89.5%	89.7%
Year 5	91.7%	92.0%	91.9%
Year 6	93.5%	88.0%	89.7%
Year 7	88.7%	88.3%	88.4%
Year 8	87.7%	85.8%	86.7%
Year 9	85.6%	83.0%	84.3%
Year 10	89.3%	85.6%	86.8%
Year 11	90.5%	87.6%	89.3%
Year 12	90.2%	92.0%	91.0%

Student Non-Attendance

All student non-attendance is followed up according to the DCS Attendance Policy, available on OurDCS.

Parents are encouraged to contact the school by 10:00 am on the day of a student’s absence to notify the school of the absence.

Students whose absence remains unacknowledged after 10:00 am are followed up with a phone call or text message to a parent to acknowledge an absence. All unacknowledged absences at the end of two weeks will generate a letter to parents requesting acknowledgment of the unacknowledged absences.

External Testing Results

2024 Higher School Certificate

(HSC) We are pleased that in 2024, 34 students successfully completed their studies and received a Higher School Certificate (HSC). These 34 students sat HSC examinations in 28 subjects, including three subjects studied through other institutions. 12 students, 35% of the Year 12 cohort, included non-examinable subjects in their program of study.

Subjects included extension vocational education and life skills courses. The number of students studying each course ranged from three to 18, with an average class size of six students.

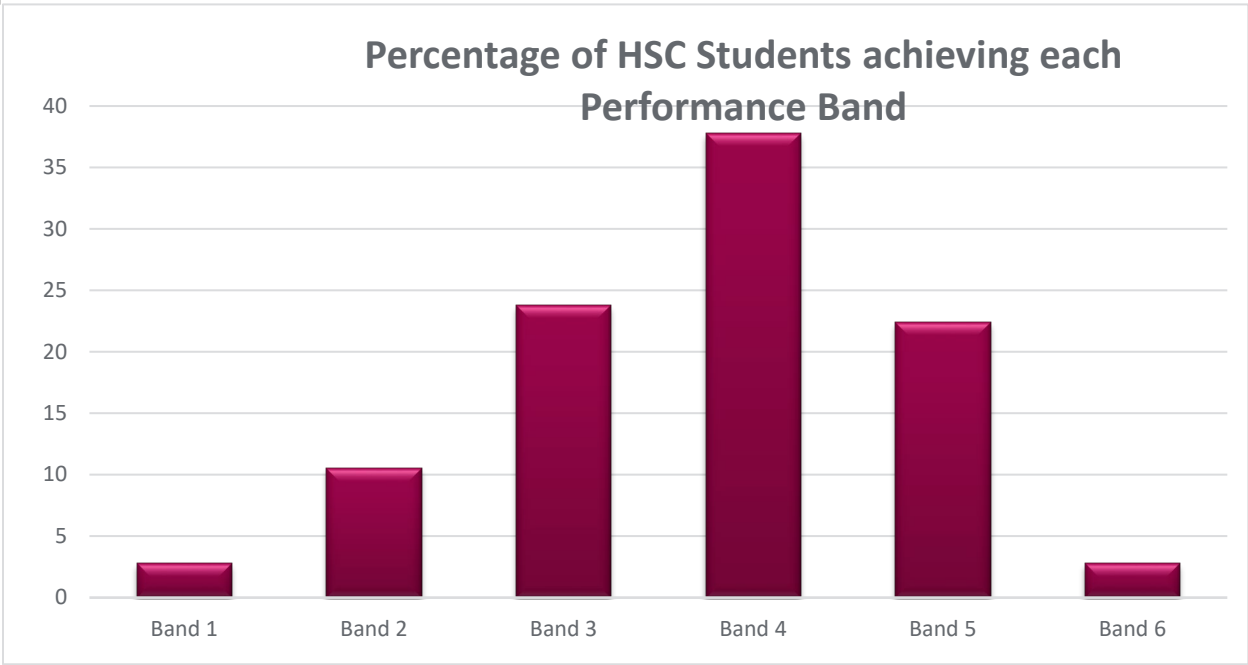
The school examination mean was above or within 2% of the State average for

six subjects (more data on graphs on the next page).

Three students achieved Band 6 or Notional Band 6 scores in one or more subjects.

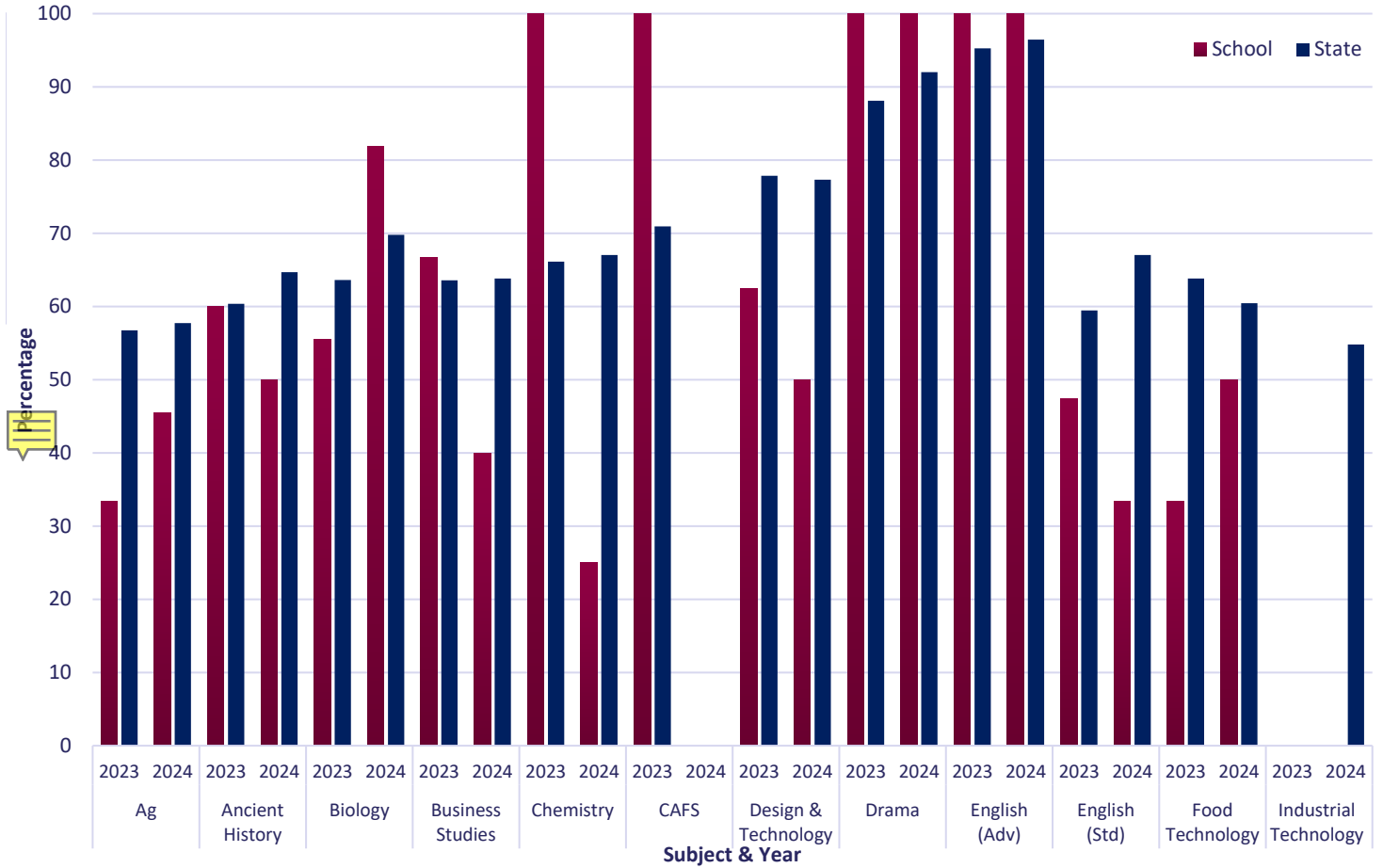
Eighteen students received Band 5 scores in at least one subject and 10 of these in more than one subject.

Nine students (26%) were enrolled in VET courses, three at DCS and 8 at other institutions. Eight achieved a Certificate II in Agriculture and three achieved a Certificate I in Engineering and a statement of attainment towards Certificate II in Engineering Pathways.

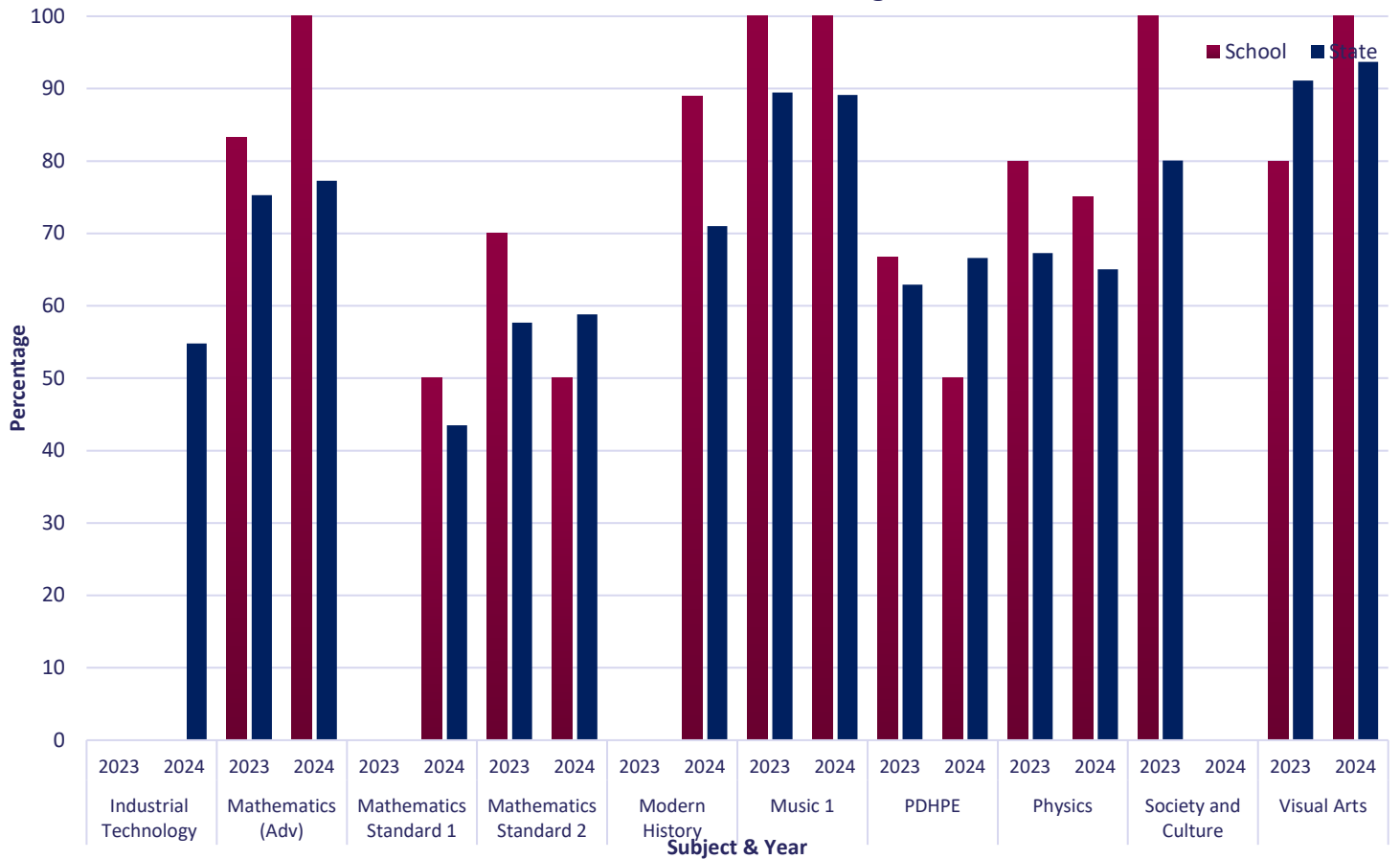


Percentage of HSC

% of HSC students achieving bands 4-6 School vs State for 2023-2024

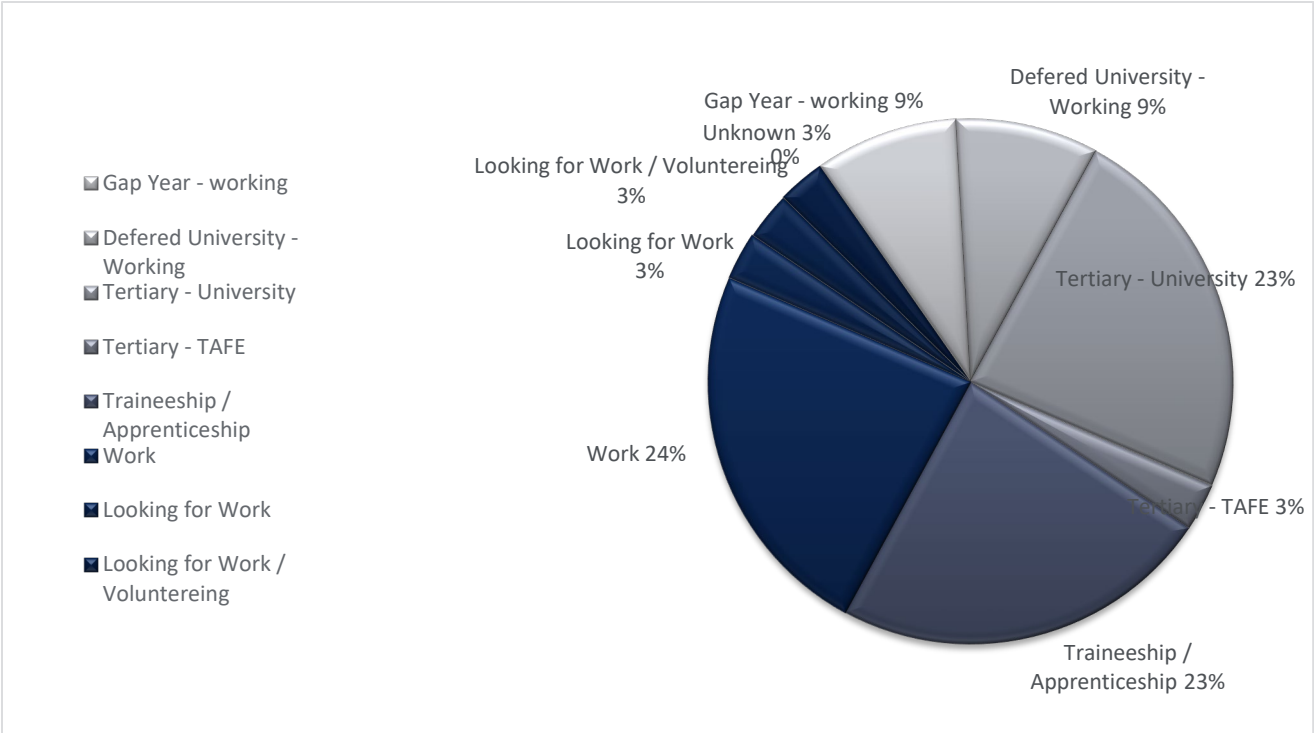


% of HSC students achieving bands 4-6 School vs State for 2023-2024



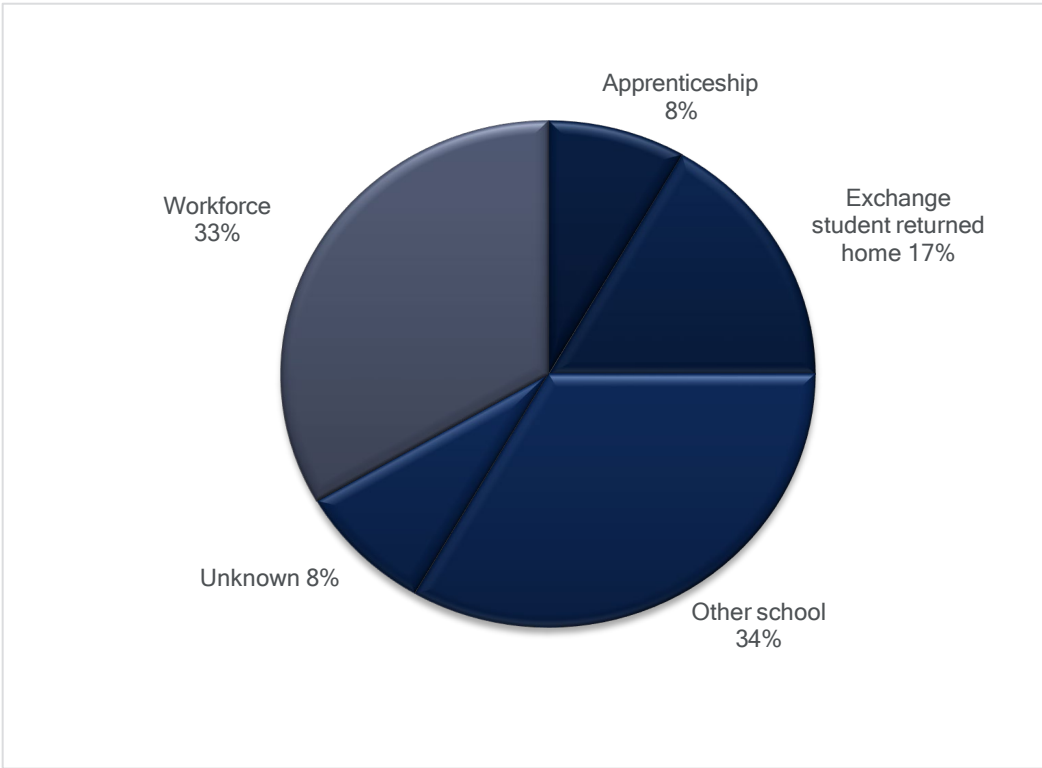
Post HSC Destinations

The chart below shows the post-school destinations of our Year 12 students in 2024.



Post DCS Destinations

The chart below shows the post-school destinations of students leaving DCS after turning 17 or leaving formal education prior to turning 17.



2024 Record of School Achievement (RoSA)

All 66 of the Year 10 students at DCS became eligible for a Record of School Achievement in 2024.

2024 NAPLAN Testing (Years 3, 5, 7 and 9)

DCS students sat NAPLAN online in

2024. Key Points:

- 2024 testing shows that results remain strong across Years 3, 5, 7 and 9.
- The percentage of students requiring additional support range from 0% to 17%. Those domains with greater than 5% requiring support were Year 3 Grammar 12%, Year 5 Grammar 7%; Year 7 Reading and Writing 6%, Year 7 Spelling, Grammar and Numeracy 8 %, Year 9 Reading 8%, Year 9 Writing 11%, Year 9 Spelling 10% and Year9 Grammar 17%

Average student results at Dubbo Christian School for 2023

	Reading	Writing	Spelling	Grammar	Numeracy
Year 3	438.4	441.6	405.7	431.9	433.6
Year 5	522.3	493.3	497.4	520.9	517.7
Year 7	535.5	547.1	530.7	551.4	548
Year 9	577.7	565	561.6	565.9	586.7

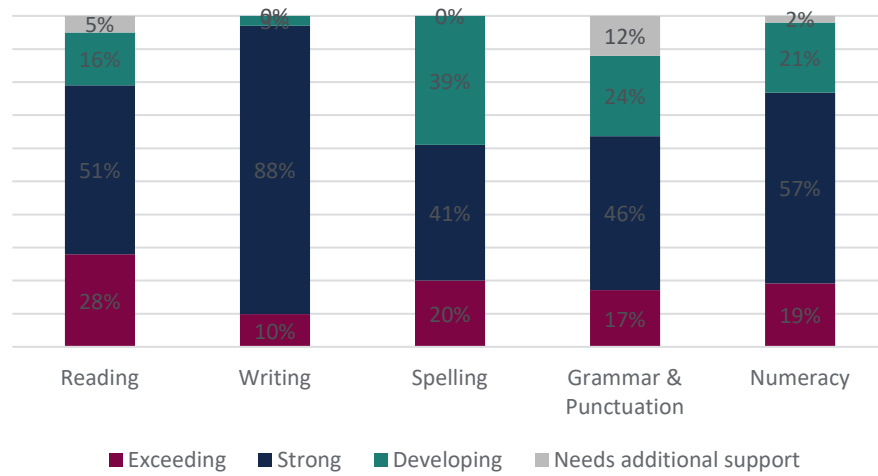
The following pages show two graphs for each year group

- the first shows the percentage of students achieving each proficiency level for each testing domain.
- The second shows the variation in test scores over the past 5 NAPLAN tests (noting that there were no tests in 2020)

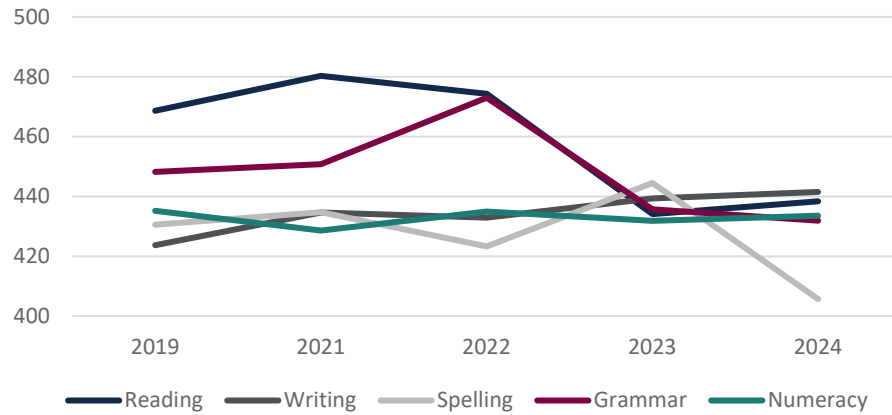
There is a third graph for year 9 showing the growth in average scores for the cohort from Year 3 to Year 9, although they have no Year 5 results from 2020.

Year 3

Year 3 Proficiency Level

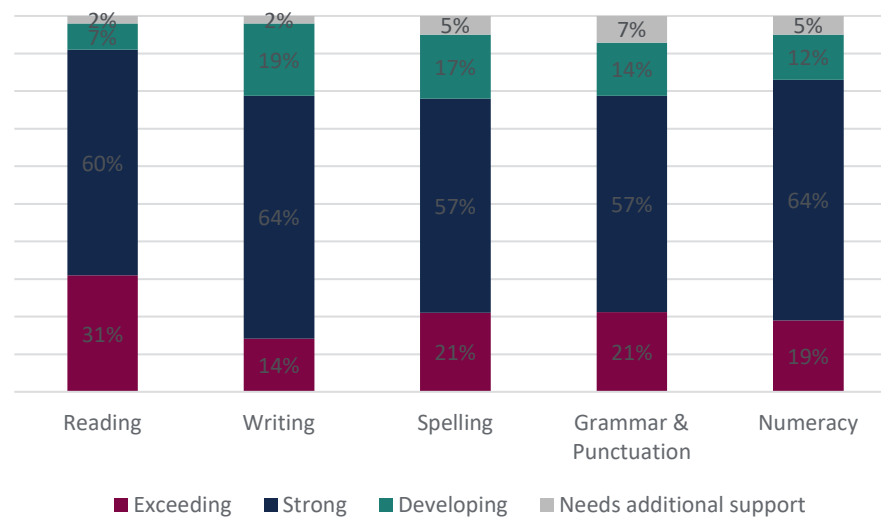


Year 3 NAPLAN Average Scores

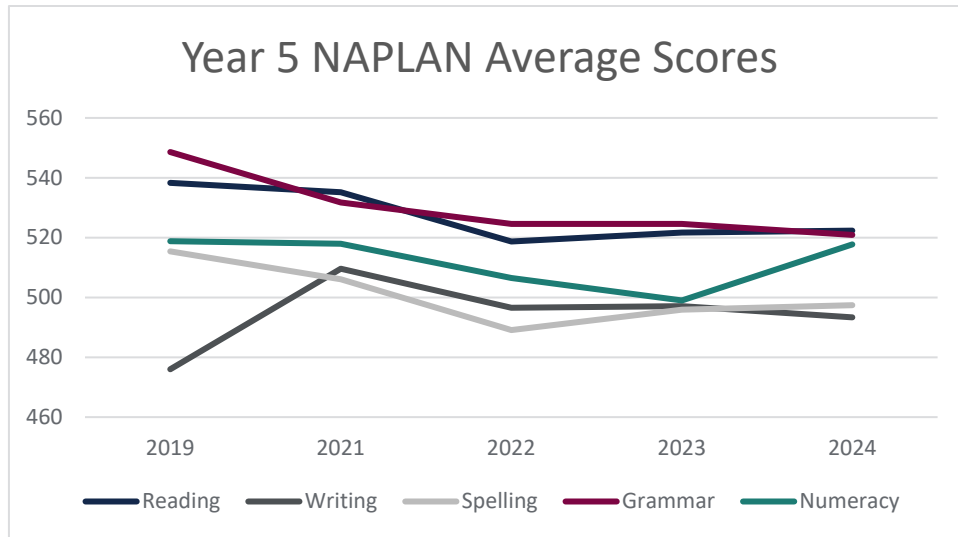


Year 5

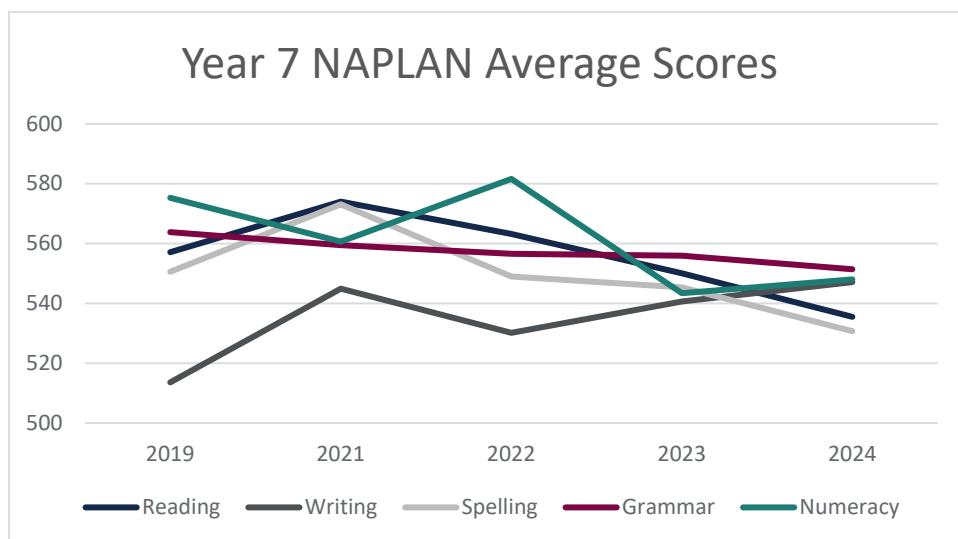
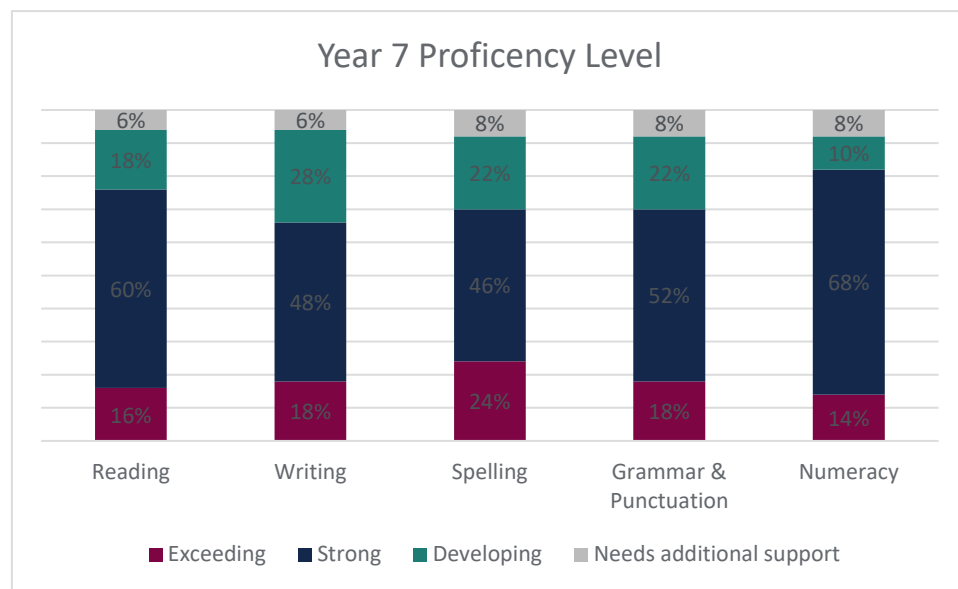
Year 5 Proficiency Level



Year 5

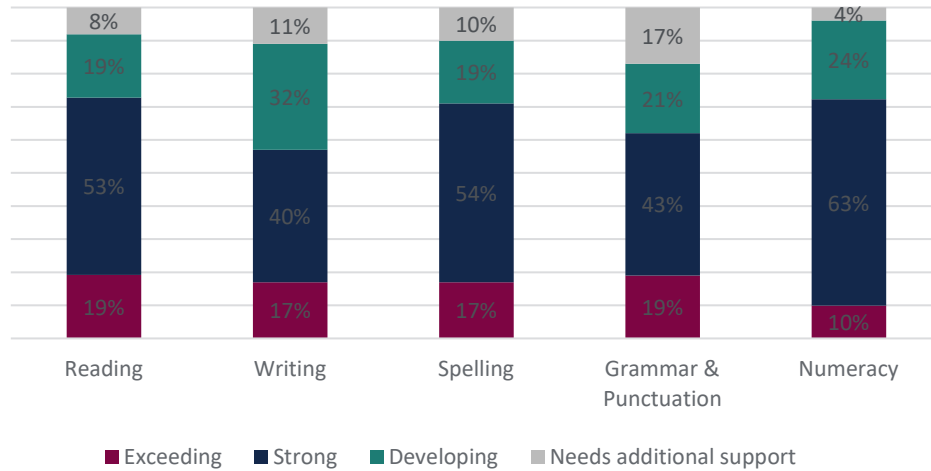


Year 7

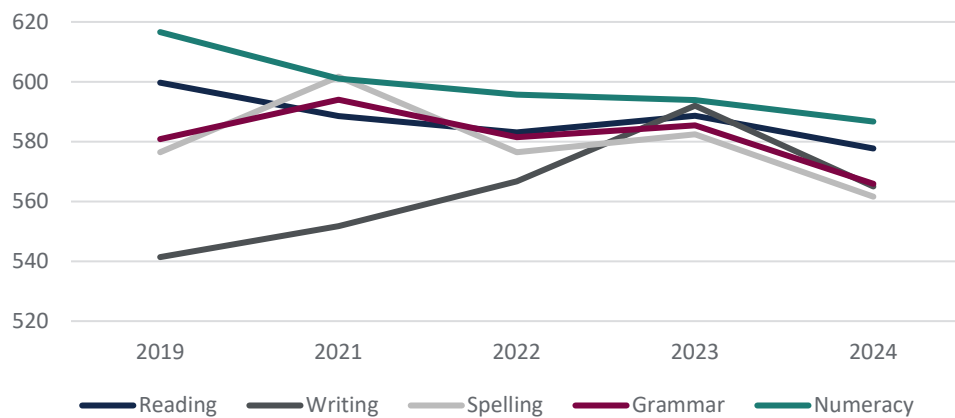


Year 9

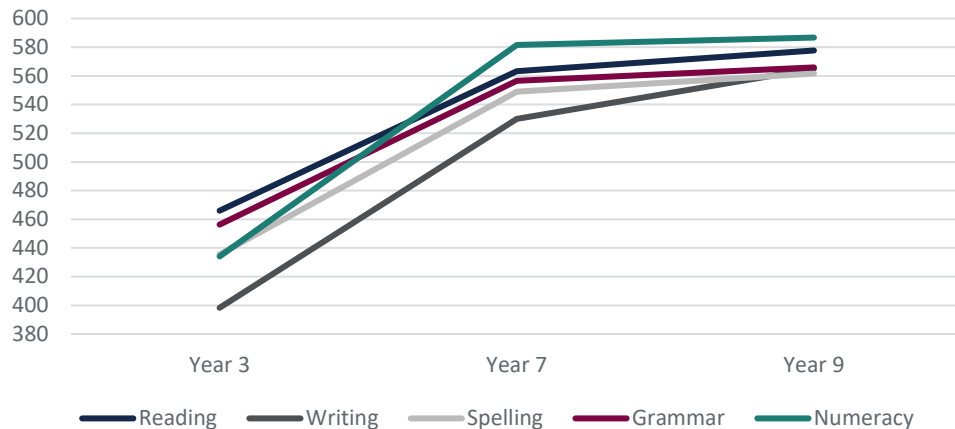
Year 9 Proficiency Level



Year 9 NAPLAN Average Scores



Cohort averages over time - Year 9 2024



Teacher Standards

Employment and Qualifications

During 2024, DCS employed a total of 63 teachers filling 51.3 full-time equivalent (FTE) positions. There were 37 full-time teachers, and 29 part-time teachers.

There was one teacher on leave for part of 2024. Two permanent teaching staff employed in 2023 did not return in 2024. This is a 97% retention rate of teaching staff from 2023 to 2024.

65 teachers have teaching qualifications from a higher education institution within Australia or as recognized within the National Office of Overseas Skills Recognition (AEI-NOOSR) guidelines. One full-time and two part-time teachers were employed while completing their studies for their teaching qualification.

Four teachers currently hold relevant Masters Degrees. Staff teaching experience ranges from 0.4 - 44 years with an average of 12.4 years.

The school is registered as a Teacher Accreditation Authority (TAA) under the New South Wales Education Standards Authority (NESA). There were four staff who were provisionally registered, one of whom attained Professional Competence during 2024. There were three staff who were conditionally registered.

In 2024, there were 17 full-time and 35 part-time non-teaching staff.

Two staff members identified as being Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander.



Teacher Development

In 2024 DCS had a full day's PD in Peacewise Australia's "Peacewise Training" Course in the January Professional Development week. This is part of preparing the staff for the implementation of Peacewise kids in 2024, which will equip students to better manage conflict and build healthy relationships. Staff also attended the four-day CEN ITEC Conference in Perth that was well received.

Additionally, Waratah Project initiatives are continuing in which respective PD has been conducted.

The teaching staff continue to meet each Monday after school for in-servicing and PD. The role our appraisal system plays is also important as staff are encouraged in their goals and targeted PD is provided as they work towards their agreed goals.

During the days the following areas were addressed:

- Culture Changes and the Christian School
- Privacy
- Child Protection Training
- First Aid Training
- Birth Battle Build – A new Biblical Literacy program from CEN
- RANGS Changes
- Enhancing Classroom Practice
- Student with Disability Briefings
- Trauma Informed Practice

All staff are trained in dealing with anaphylaxis, asthma, and diabetes

Other courses attended by our staff in 2024 included:

- ACHPER PDHPE Conference
- AIS EAL/D Network Meeting
- AIS Science PD
- AIS VET Conference 2024 - Lifting the VET Experience for ALL
- AISNSW Mathematics Conference
- AISNSW Sports Leadership Conference
- AISNSW VET Manufacturing Assessment Tool Development with Catherine Sip
- Autism and ADHD in the classroom
- Big Jigger PD
- Business Studies in Sydney
- CEN Leaders Conference
- CEN Learning Support Coordinators Meeting
- Chemical Safety in Schools Basic and Advanced PD
- CPI Instructor Renewal
- CSSA COM Budget Meeting
- Dealing with Difficult Parents Masterclass
- DRAMA NSW Syllabus Inservice
- English Conference
- Equipped to Lead CEN Conference
- ETA Australian Literature Seminar
- History Extension PD
- HMS Unit Design PD
- HSC Marking Briefing
- Inclusive Schooling Summit

- Introduction to Textiles PD
- LawSense Harmful Sexualised Behaviours between Students
- Leading EAL/D Support & Teaching
- MacLit training
- Maths PD course
- MCA Teacher Prof Development Day
- MIGDAS Autism Assessment Training
- NAPLAN Coordinator's PD
- National Japanese Teachers Symposium
- NESA HSC Exam Assessor
- New syllabus PD
- SPELD Evidence Based Reading in Action
- SPELD Strategies for Struggling Readers
- Peter and the Starcatcher Masterclass
- Playbuilding workshop
- Problematic Behaviours
- Programming new Maths syllabus
- Ancient History - Pompeii and Herculaneum Stage 6 Seminar
- Stage 6 syllabus PD - English
- STANSW Conference - Sydney
- Step Up Middle Leaders Training 2025
- Sue Larkey Training
- TAS Conference
- Teaching Child Studies
- Thrive Workshop
- CEN T&L Leaders' Summit
- Gen AI for School Leaders
- UNSW Pedagogical Narrative Face to Face Day
- UNSW Pedagogy Project
- VET Competency Conversation
- Visual Arts (Life Skills)
- Waratah Aboriginal Spirituality and Hub Day
- Waratah Project Meetings and Network Days
- WATL Conference

Dubbo Christian School was part of the NESA Teacher Expert Networks (TENs) in 2024. This opportunity provides preparation for implementation of the new curriculum through representation on the network and associated professional development.



Satisfaction with School

Our school community commits to following Jesus' example of serving and acting in love towards one another. We aim for this to become a reality among and between all members of our community – students, staff and parents.

We recognise that it is inevitable that at times we will disappoint each other, but as much as we are able, we aim to work positively for the good of our children and of the whole school community. Parents, students and staff were surveyed about their satisfaction with the school.

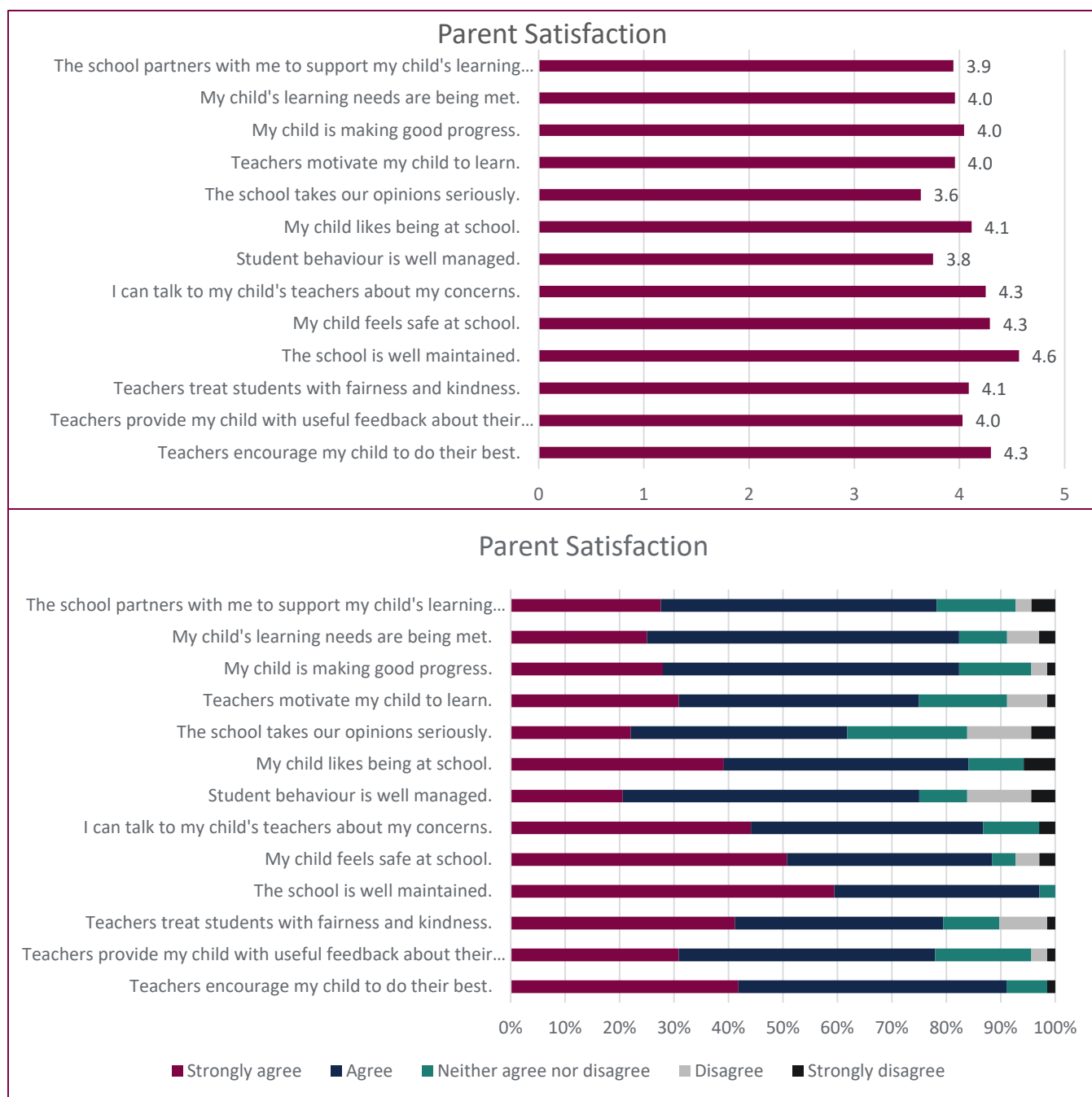
Responses are summarised on the following pages.

Grandparents Day 2024

Parents



Parents

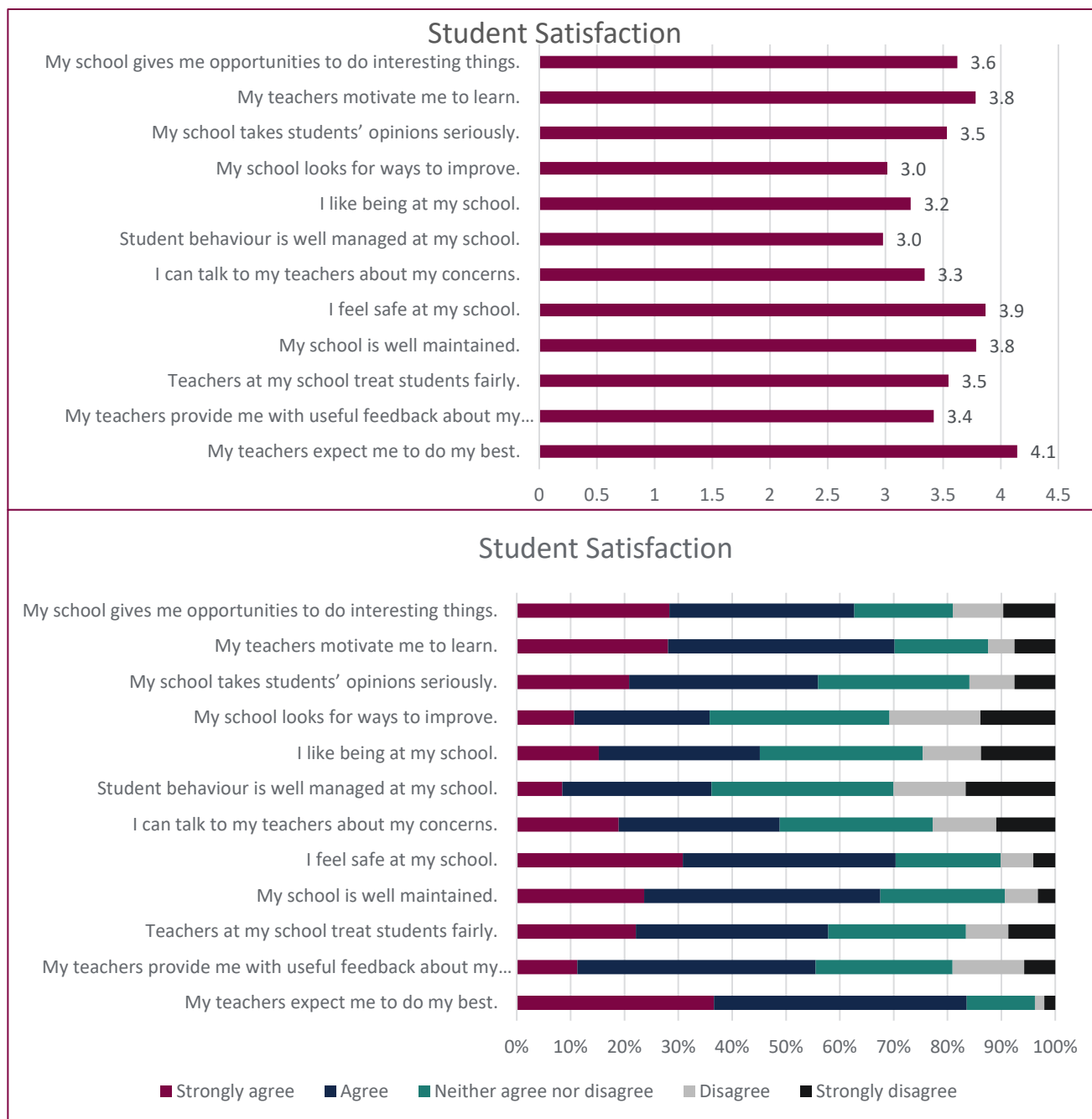


Parent satisfaction with the school continues to be strong. Particular strengths were again in how well maintained the school is, how safe children feel and children's enjoyment of school. Parents expressed satisfaction in the strong affirmation of teacher's expectations for their children. It is also notable that they feel they can talk to their child's teacher when they have concerns. There was improvement in how seriously the school takes parents' opinions, but more work can be done. Parents are always encouraged to contact us if they have other suggestions on how we can improve.

Statistically, the results of the survey have not changed significantly in 2024 but it is notable that while we only had 17 responses in 2023 we had 69 responses this year and that is most encouraging.

If success were to be measured by size and numbers, then strong parent satisfaction is evident in that the school continues to grow at a steady rate, with wait lists in both the Primary and the Secondary. Parents also mention strong community perception and regard for the school amongst their friends, family and work colleagues.

Students



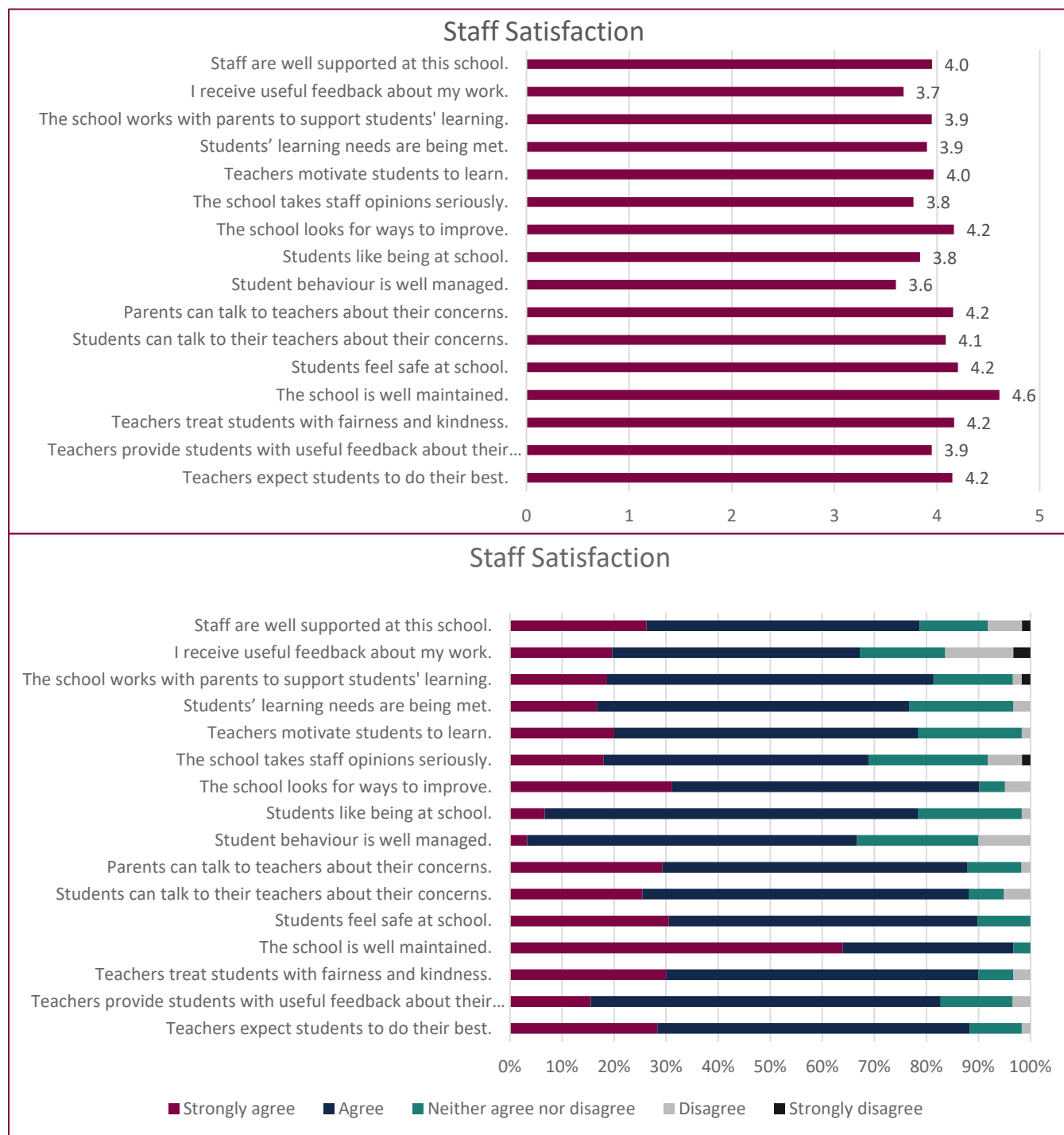
Students expressed a high level of satisfaction with the school. Particular strengths, as in previous years, continued to be high teacher expectations and how safe our students feel at school.

Students also endorsed our well-maintained facilities as a strength.

The area that students indicated the least satisfaction was staff management of poor student behaviour. Concern also exists for how seriously the school took their opinions and in the approachability of teachers to discuss concerns were also noted with 1 in 4 students dissatisfied.

Final areas of strong endorsement were that students felt the school gave them opportunities to do interesting things and that their teachers motivated them to learn.

Staff

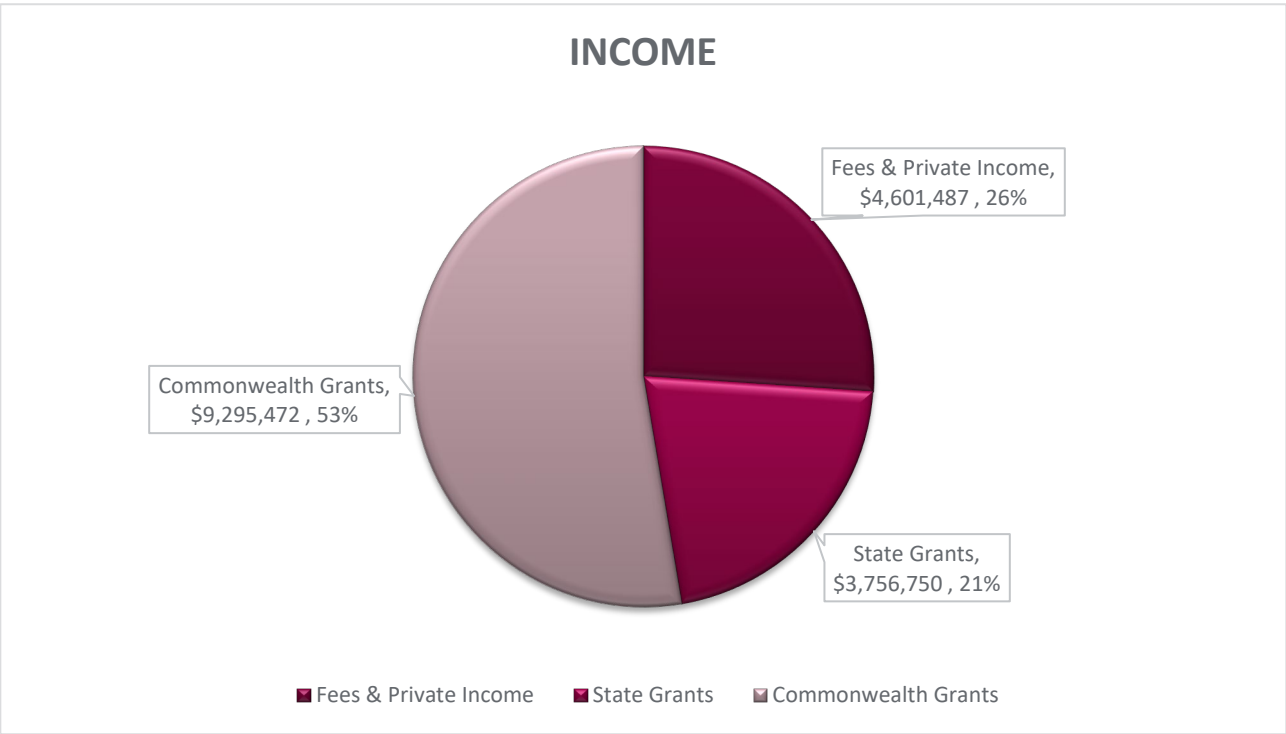
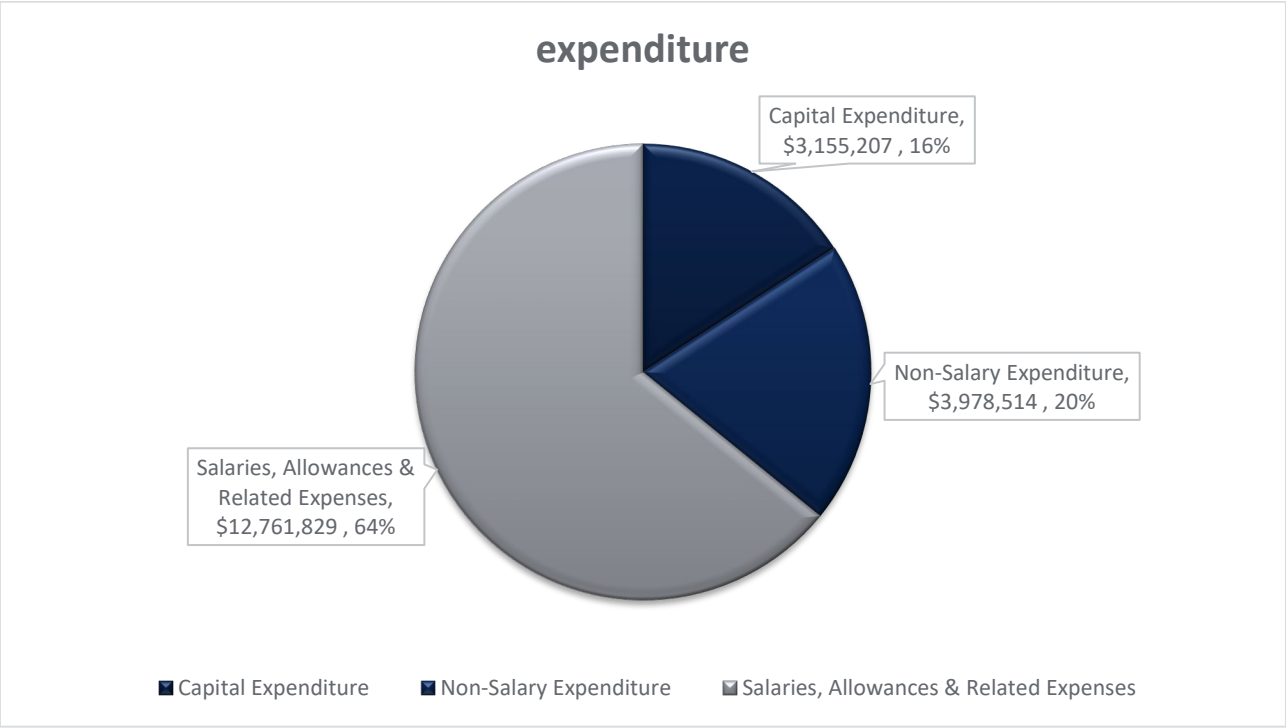


Once again, staff expressed a pleasing level of satisfaction with the school. Strengths identified were in how safe students feel at school as well as the maintenance of school facilities and the way the school works with parents to support student learning. It was also noted that the school looks for ways to improve.

The high expectations of teachers also rated positively as did the fact that the teachers treat students with fairness and kindness. Happily, there was very low teaching staff turnover and by year's end, the school was again fully staffed. Staff did note that they would appreciate more feedback on their performance.

Financial Information

The following is a summary for the 2024 financial year, based on amounts declared in The Berakah Christian Education Ltd 2024 Financial Statements.



Net profit 2024: \$592,174

School Priorities 2024-2025

Priority areas identified and addressed for 2024 included:

Our 2024 priorities include:

1. **Academic Improvement:** to continue its focus on building academic rigor and fostering a strong learning culture
2. **Christian Distinctiveness:** to continue key programs to re-enforce the school's Christian distinctiveness
3. **Student Wellbeing and Spiritual Formation:** to implement new student wellbeing and spiritual formation programs
4. **Culture Building:** to continue to build upon culture setting, in particular at key student entry points
5. **Parental Connection and Community:** to continue to improve parental connection and sense of community
6. **School Infrastructure:** to continue its capital works program according to the school's infrastructure plan



Respect and Responsibility

Respect and responsibility is a vital part of our vision of Christian Education. As our students grow, they are challenged to respond to God's mercy and love for them. This is lived out through loving and respecting others and being responsible for their own actions and attitudes in community. The latter is especially key as the concept of living positively and sacrificially in community is essential in Christian philosophy and worldview.

Stemming from this foundational position, our discipline and welfare policies reinforce personal responsibility and accountability for one's own choices. These are key prerequisites for appreciating the value of others. Our policies also focus on the impact of individual decisions on the community, especially promoting consideration for needs of others and the group above individual interest.

In practice, our Pastoral Care Groups are engaged in community support, charity or welfare work in the wider community throughout the year. Class groups engage with disabled, aged and underprivileged groups and individuals. Through these activities, our students practically learn to appreciate others and their value as part of the wider community.

Student expectations are clearly communicated in the DCS Student Code of Conduct, which is displayed in every classroom. It is based on the phrase "The DCS Way" and articulates that how we think as a school is important for learning and growing together in a way that honours God and respects others. These positive messages aim to provide clear parameters for all students as well as a consistent basis for behaviour and work habits in all classes.

Students in the K-6 section of the school are united under the catchcries of "Kind Words, Kind Actions" and "We're all in this together". These mottos, now on a mural in the K-6 area of the school, encourage all students to treat each other with respect and work together as a team. We are pleased to see over the years how students have upheld these messages as they progress into secondary school and beyond.

Information Regarding Key Policies

These key policies may be found on www.dubbocs.edu.au:

- [Enrolment policy](#)
- [Child Protection policy](#)
- [Student Welfare](#)
- [Anti-bullying policy](#)
- [Discipline policy](#)
- [Complaints policy](#)



